Worksheet 2: The Big Four Verbs

Mastering BE, HAVE, DO, and GO — The Engine of Everyday English

Why These Four? Together, **BE, HAVE, DO,** and **GO** make up a huge percentage of all spoken English. If you master their present and past forms—and avoid translating Italian expressions literally (like *"ho 25 anni"* or *"ho fame"*)—your English will immediately sound natural.

1. Quick Reference: Present & Past Forms

Verb	Present (I / You / We / They)	Present (He / She / It)	Past Simple
BE (essere)	am / are	is	was / were
HAVE (avere)	have	has	had
DO (fare)	do	does	did
GO (andare)	go	goes	went

2. Watch Out: Italian "Avere" vs. English "BE"

In Italian, you use *avere* for age, hunger, thirst, and temperature. In English, you must use **BE**!

- ~~I have 28 years.~~ → **I am 28 years old.**
- ~~I have hungry / cold.~~ → **I am hungry / cold.**

3. Exercise A: Choose the Correct Verb

1. Yesterday, we _____ (go / went) to the cinema.
2. _____ (Do / Does) your brother live in Rome?
3. I _____ (am / have) very thirsty! Can I have some water?
4. She _____ (have / has) a new car, and it _____ (is / are) red.
5. They _____ (was / were) at the restaurant last night.

4. Exercise B: Complete the Questions & Negatives

Use **do, does, don't, doesn't,** or **didn't**.

1. _____ you like coffee? — Yes, I _____.
2. He _____ go to work yesterday because he was sick.
3. Where _____ Maria live?
4. We _____ have enough time to finish this today.

5. Exercise C: Fix the Italian-Style Mistakes

1. My father have 60 years. → _____
2. She goed to London last summer. → _____
3. Do he work here? → _____



Answer Key

Ex A: 1. went | 2. Does | 3. am | 4. has, is | 5. were

Ex B: 1. Do, do | 2. didn't | 3. does | 4. don't

Ex C: 1. My father is 60 years old. | 2. She went to London last summer. | 3. Does he work here?